agreed Salim, ‘it must have been a hereditary trait since her father (Raja Bhagwant Das) and brothers (Man Singh, Madho Singh) all used suddenly to appear quite mad, but after a while they would calm down.’ Salim found himself laid low by the death of his first bride, who ‘would have sacrificed a thousand sons and brothers for one hair of mine’. He was unable to eat or drink for days, and the pleasure leached out of his life. Akbar, who had been very fond of Shah Begum, heard of his son’s distress and sent him a kind letter of condolence accompanied by a robe of honour and his own turban. The turban would have been a comforting sign to Salim of the Padshah reconfirming Salim’s position as his heir apparent.

While Salim mourned his Rajput bride, the artists in his taswir khana began works in a style shaped by the holy city the images were born in. After all, just below the great fort of Allahabad were the banks of the holy rivers which were haunted by the sacrifices, penances, practices, and truths of the yogis and mystics. The Sufi mystic Shaikh Muhammad Ghaus of Gwalior had compiled a Persian translation of an Arabic text called the ‘Pool of Life’, rendered as the *Bahar al-Hayat* (Ocean of Life) describing twenty-one yoga asanas. Salim had this text copied and illustrated in his ateliers and his artists drew the different asanas of yoga, showing the fascination that Salim had for the unusual contortions that he must have observed for himself from the fort of Allahabad. Akbar, too, had had paintings of yogis made but in Salim’s case, the artists would have had regular access to practising yogis on the banks of the river and the images in the *Bahar al-Hayat* are careful and sensitive portrayals of the yogis in different asanas, surrounded by their meagre possessions. The paintings are simply drawn, with a light wash through which the underlying paper can be seen. They are the works of young artists, still immature, and are the grist around which the pearls of Jahangir’s mature taswir khana would be created.

While Salim was consoling himself with drink, opium, and art in Allahabad, unsatisfactory reports continued to arrive in Agra from the Deccan, not only of Daniyal’s intemperate drinking but also of his inability to rapidly secure a bride, as promised, from Ibrahim Adil Shah II of Bijapur. A Mughal officer, a Persian scholar called Mir Jamal-ud Din Husain Inju Shirazi, had been sent some years previously to Bijapur as an envoy to arrange for the marriage between Daniyal and Ibrahim Adil Shah II’s daughter. But Ibrahim Adil Shah II had decided, in the face of